PROJECT 10073 RECORD CARD

1. DATE

24 Sep 59

2. LOCATION

Redmond, Oregon

3. DATE-TIME GROUP

Local 1200Z

GMT

4. TYPE OF OBSERVATION

☐ Ground-Visual ☐ Ground-Radar

☐ Air-Visual ☐ Air-Intercept Radar

5. PHOTOS

☐ Yes

☐ No

6. SOURCE

Civilian

7. LENGTH OF OBSERVATION

not given

8. NUMBER OF OBJECTS

one

9. COURSE

South

10. BRIEF SUMMARY OF SIGHTING

Bright light, suchas landing light, changing to orangeish. Four protruding lights red, green, yellow, & white. Falling white light hovered at 800 feet, then rose to 3000feet. Still in sight at time of rpt.

11. COMMENTS

Refraction of Venus & Regulus possible since both were just below horizon at time of sighting. (See //Case file)

12. CONCLUSIONS

- ☐ Was Balloon
- ☐ Probably Balloon
- ☐ Possibly Balloon
- ☐ Was Aircraft
- ☐ Probably Aircraft
- ☐ Possibly Aircraft
- ☐ Was Astronomical
- ☐ Probably Astronomical Venus
- ☐ Possibly Astronomical
- ☐ Other
- ☐ Insufficient Data for Evaluation
- ☐ Unknown

ATIC FORM 329 (REV 26 SEP 52)

STAFF MESSAGE DIVISION
UNCLASSIFIED MESSAGE
INCOMING

AF IN : 54154 (24 Sep 59) B/A/cs
ACTION: CIN
INFO : OOP, SAFS

SMD C 166

CZCHQC272ZCQJA093

OO RJEZHQ

DE ROWZBG 154A

O 241326Z

FM 1902 AACSRON HAMILTON AFB CALIFORNIA

TO RJWFAL/ADC ENT AFB

RJWZSB/28ADIV HAMILTON AFB

RJEDSQ/ATIC WRIGH PATTERSON AFB

RJEZHQ/OFS USAF

RJWZDM/25TH DIV MCCORD AFB

BT

UNCLAS FROM FLT SVC SIE NUMBER ONE ACION ADC 28 ADIV ATIC AFCIN AFOIS.

UFO.

A. (1) BRIGHT LIGHT SUCH AS LANDING LIGHS

(2) AT ARMS LENGTH SIZE OF CIGARETE

(3) WHITE LIGHT CHANGING TO ORANGISH

(4) ONE

(5) N/A

(6) SEE M 6

(7) N/A

(8) N/A

(9) FOUR PROTRUDING LIGHTS RED GREEN YELLOW AND WHITE

B. FALLING WHITE LIGHT THEN HOVERED AT 800FT THEN RISING TO 3000FT

DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
STAFF MESSAGE DIVISION
UNCLASSIFIED MESSAGE
INCOMING

(2) 12 DEGREES

(3) 24/1319Z APPOX 50 MI SOUTH TRAVELING SOUTH

(4) N/A

(5) IN FLIGHT TO THE SOUTH

(6) STARTED AT 24/1200Z SEPT TILL PRESENT TIME

C. (1) GROUND VISUAL BY NAKED EYE

(2) BINOCULARS BU NOT NEEDED

(3) N/A

D. (1) 24/1200Z SEPT 959

(2) NIGHT

E. REDMOND, FAA STATION OPERATOR, REDMOND OREGON CALL LETTERS RDM
REDMOND CITY POLICEMAN OREGON

F. (1) LAVERNE WERTZ 304 S 7H ST REDMOND OREGON FAA FL SVC SPECIALIST
ROBERT DICKERSON 534 S 11TH ST REDMOND OREG POLICE LINCOLN 82945

(2) N/A

G. (1) HAMILTON FLIGHT SERVICE FOCST

(2) SSE 5 6,000 270/10
350/20 010/20 010/20
330/15

5) HIGH THIN BROKEN

STAFF MESSAGE DIVISION
UNCLASSIFIED MESSAGE
INCOMING

(4) 45

(5) 6-8/10 CI ON CS

(6) NONE

H. NONE

I. 28TH AND 25TH ADIV NOTIFIED AT 24/1232Z AND 24/1244Z SCRAMBLE LATER OUT OF PORTLAND AFB ORG

J. JINGO 36 B47 MOUNTAIN HOME AFB IDAHO ROUND ROBIN IN AREA AT 36000FT NEGATIVE SIGHTING

K. HAMILTON FLT SVC CLNC OFFICER WAS RECEIVING CONINUOUS REPORTS FROM SEATTLE ARTC CENTER RELAYING FOR RDM RADIO

L. N/A

M. FOUR PROTRUDING LIGHTS WOULD GO OU AND THEN COME BACK ON AND FAN TAILED ON THE END. AT APPROXIMATELY 24/1259Z SEPT DISAPPEARED INTO CLOUDS AT 14000FT ACCENDING APPROXIMATELY 4000FT PER MINUTE PROTRUDING COLORED LIGHTS WHERE OUT BUT ORANGE LIGHT SIMILAR TO JET BLAST CAME FROM BOTTOM. SIGHED AGAIN AT APPROX 24/1325Z BY REDMOND (MR. WERTZ) FAA STATION ESTIMATING 35000F SOUTH EAS RAVELING SOUTH AT GOOD SPEED 25 TH ADIV CAPT HESS USAF NOTIFIED

MR WERTZ HOME PHONE NUMBER LIBER[redacted]

THIS INFO RELAYED BY MR [redacted] SUPERVISOR SEATLE ARC CENTER WASHINGTON HOME ADDRES[redacted]OUTH FEDERAL WAY WASH PHONE[redacted]43 DISAPPERED 24/1319Z

BT

FEDERAL AVIATION AGENCY

Redmond Oregon.
Jan. 15, 1960

TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN.

The following in the original records on file at this facility and is all the information contained in this record concerning UFO sighted September 24, 1959. Taken from log of this date.

1259Z Robert Dickerson Redmond city police reported strange bright light descending rapidly north of the station. At several hundred feet it stopped and hovered for several minutes. He drove toward it on the Prineville highway and turned in toward the airport. At this time the light turned orange and it moved to the northeast of the station very rapidly. Relocated approximately 10 miles northeast of the station estimated 3000 feet.

1310Z Reported object to Seattle Air Route Control Center. We continued to observe UFO. Stayed very steady and projected long tongues of red, yellow and green light. These tongues of light varied in length and extended and retracted at irregular times. Observed high speed aircraft approaching from southeast. As aircraft approached UFO took shape of mushroom, observed long yellow and red flame from lower side as UFO rose rapidly and disappeared above clouds estimated 14,000 feet, scattered layer. UFO reappeared south of Redmond approximately 20 miles estimated 25,000 feet. Seattle Air Route Control Center advised radar contacted UFO at 1310Z located 25 miles south of Redmond at 52,000 feet. No further sightings made at this station.

1311Z Seattle Air Route Control Center advised UFO still 25 miles south of Redmond, various altitudes from 6,000 to 52,000 feet.

L.E. Davis
Chief, Redmond Air Traffic
Communication Station.

FEDERAL AVIATION AGENCY
Air Route Traffic Control Center
Room 132 Administration Building
Seattle-Tacoma Airport
Seattle 88, Washington

TO WHOM IT MAY CONCERN:

The following information has been extracted from the official records on file at this Center. This is all of the information we have available on the unidentified flying object sighted near Redmond, Oregon on September 24, 1959.

Time
1400Z — Redmond Communicator (FAA AFSS) and Redmond City Policeman reports sighting unidentified flying object near Redmond Airport. This report forwarded by Seattle Center personnel to Military Flight Service, Portland Air Force Base. UFO also seen on the radar at the Klamath Falls CAI site. F-102's scrambled from Portland.

1530Z — The Klamath Falls CAI site still plotting the UFO sighted in 1400Z sorty. Object is hovering 30 miles south of Redmond. Altitude has been observed on height finder at altitudes that vary from 6000 to 24,000 feet.

1620Z — Jet-Power departed Redmond with survey sorty to look over site UFO.

William F. Gamble, Jr.
Chief, Seattle ARTC Center

AF IN : 54990 (25 Mar 60)

ACTION: SAFS

INFO : CIN, OCP

DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
STAFF MESSAGE DIVISION
UNCLASSIFIED MESSAGE

INCOMING

SMD SMD C 140

CZCQEEAAWWWWWWWWWWWZCQJB 791

PP RJEZHQ

ZDK

MGA751

PP RJEDSQ RJEZHQ

DE. RJWZDMG 4

P 242215Z

FM COMDR 827 ACWRON SQ KENO ORE

TO RJEZHQ/SECRETARY OF THE AIR FORCE

INFO RJWZSB/COMDR 1902 AACS

RJEDSQ/COMDR ATIC

RJWZBH/COMDR 25TH AIRDIV

BT

/UNCLASS/827TH OPS 81. ATTN: SAS 01-3D. SUBJECT: REFERENCE TELEPHONE FROM MAJOR TACKER, THIS DATE.

A. THE CLASSIFIED LOGS FOR THIS STATION FOR 24 SEPTEMBER 1959 HAVE BEEN THROUGHLY RESEARCHED AND THE FOLLOWING INFORMATION EXTRACTED AND PARAPHRASED.

1300Z-ACTIVE AIR DEFENSE SCRAMBLE OF TWOF-102 S FROM PORTLAND INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT TO IDENTIFY UNKNOWN FLYING OBJECT. (NOTE: THIS UFOB WAS GIVEN THE TRACK NUMBER OF JB129. THE RECORDER S LOGS FOR THAT DATE, WHICH WOULD SHOW SPEED AND ALTITUDE PERFORMANCE OF THE TRACK HAVE BEEN DESTROYED. REFERENCE:

DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
STAFF MESSAGE DIVISION
UNCLASSIFIED MESSAGE

INCOMING

AF IN : 54990 (25 Mar 60)

PAGE TWO RJWZDMG 4

AFM 181-5PAR 190409, PAGE 168, DTD 20 FEBRUARY 1958, RECORDER S LOGS AND INTERCEPT ACTION REPORTS WILL BE DESTROYED AFTER THREE MONTHS).

1311Z-AIRCRAFT AIRBORNE UNDER CONTROL OF MOUNT HEBO RADAR SITE.

1420Z-AIRCRAFT RETURNED TO BASE WITH NEGATIVE RESULTS.

1452Z-TWO MORE AIRCRAFT SCRAMBLED FROM PORTLAND FOR CONTROL OF THIS RADAR SITE.

1517Z-25TH AIR DIVISION ORDERED TWO MORE F-102 S TO BE HELD IN READINESS.

1529Z-AIRCRAFT RETURNED TO PORTLAND WITHOUT RESULTS.

1608Z-ONE F-102 SCRAMBLED FROM PORTLAND FOR CONTROL OF THIS RADAR SITE.

1613Z-ONE CIVILIAN TRI-PACER AIRCRAFT TOOK OFF FROM REDMOND AIRPORT FOR LOW ALTITUDE SEARCH. ONE OF THE CREW MEMBERS WAS EQUPED WITH A GEIGER COUNTER.

1614Z-F-102 AIRBORNE.

1655Z-F-102 PILOT REPORTED SEEING TWO BOATS ON THE LAKE AT PAULINA MOUNTAIN AND A RADIO RELAY STATION. HE ALSO REPORTED SCATTERED CLOUD CONDITIONS AND THAT THE AIR WAS BUMPY.

1718Z-SCRAMBLED ONE F-102 FROM PORTLAND FOR CONTROL OF THIS RADAR SITE. THIS AIRCRAFT REPORTED CLOUDS FROM 20,000 DOWN TO 12,000 MSL. A FOREST RANGER STATION WAS SIGHTED NEAR

PAULINA LAKES. THIS INFORMATION WAS THEN PASSED TO THE SENIOR CONTROLLER AT.THE COMBAT OPERATIONS CENTER AT 25TH AIRDIVISION.

1821Z-TRI-PACER RETURNED TO REDMOND WITHOUT RESULTS. NO OBJECTS SIGHTED AND NO RADIATION NOTED IN THAT AREA.

1824Z-SCRAMBLED ONE F-89 FROM PORTLAND FOR CONTROL OF THIS SITE.

1929Z-F-89 RETURNED FOR RECOVERY WITH NEGATIVE RESULTS.

1949Z-SENIOR CONTROLLER AT 25TH AIR DIVISION ORDERED SCRAMBEL OF H-19 HELICOPTER OUT OF KINGSLEY FIELD.

2154Z-H-19 LANDED AT REDMOND WITH NEGATIVE RESULTS.

2155Z-25TH AIR DIVISION ORDERED TRACK NUMBER JB 129 SCRUBBED.

2203Z-AIR DEFENSE EXERCISE TERMINATED BY 25TH AIR DIVISION.

(NOTE: SEVERAL SCRAMBLES, INTERCEPTS AND RECOVERIES WERE PERFORMED BY DIVISION RADAR SITES AS PART OF THE EXERCISE DURING THE PERIOD REPORTED.)

2230Z-H-19 OREDERED TO RETURN TO KINSLEY FIELD.

B. THE SENIOR DIRECTOR ON DUTY AT THE TIME THE OBJECT WAS FIRST REPORTED WAS CAPTAIN GORDAON R. TOLAND, A01863779, WHO WAS TRANSFERRED OVERSEAS TO ICELAND AIR DEFENSE SECTOR, APO 81, NEW YOURK, PER SPECIAL ORDER A-198, THIS HEADQUARTERS, DATED 1 FEBRUARY 1960.

C. THREE OTHER DIRECTORS WHO WERE ON DUTY FROM 1500Z TO 2400Z ON 24 SEPTEMBER HAVE BEEN INTERVIEWED AND RECALL THE FOLLOWING:

1. THE RADAR RETURNS BEARING TRACK NUMBER JB129 DID NOT MOVE DURING THIS PERIOD.

2. THE RADAR RETURN WAS IN A POSITION VERY CLOSE TO A GAP FILLER ANTENNA LOCATED ON A MOUNTAIN AT THE 8010 FOOT LEVEL.

3. REPEATED PASSES WERE MADE BY INTERCEPTORS AT LEVELS FROM 40,000 DOWN TO 12,000 , THE INTERCEPTORS BEING DIRECTED THROUGH OUR RADAR RETURN OF JB 129. NO INTERCEPTOR RECEIVED A RADAR RETURN ON HIS AIRBORNE RADAR. AT ALTITUDES BELOW 12,000 MSL VISUAL SEARCH WAS CONDUCTED UNDER VFR CONDITIONS WITH NEGATIVE RESULTS.

4.SINCE 24 SEPTEMBER 1959 SEVERAL INSTANCES HAVE BEEN OBSERVED BY THESE DIRECTORS WHEREIN NON-MOVING RADAR RETURNS APPEAR IN THE SAME LOCATION AS THOSE OF JB 129. IT IS THEIR OPINION THAT UNDER CERTAIN ATMOSPHERIC CONDITIONS, RADAR ECHOES FROM THE GAP FILLER ANTENNA IN THAT LOCATION ARE RECEIVED. THIS IS PHYSICALLY POSSIBLE AND PROBABLE UNDER APPROPRIATE ATMOSPHERIC CODITIONS.

5. NO SPECIFIC UFOB REPORT WAS SUBMITTED BY THIS SQUADRON,

DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
STAFF MESSAGE DIVISION
UNCLASSIFIED MESSAGE

INCOMING

AF IN : 54990 (25 Mar 60)

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ALTHOUGH ALL INFORMATION OBTAINED WAS FORWARDED BY VOICE COMMUNICATION TO THE 25TH AIR DIVISION FOR INCLUSION IN THEIR REPORT.

THE INTELLIGENCE SECTION AT 25TH AIR DIVISION (25OIN) HAS COMPILED ADDITIONAL INFORMATION ON THIS INCIDENT. IF YOU DESIRE FURTHER INFORMATION IT IS SUGGESTED THAT THAT OFFICE BE QUERIED.

BT

24/2305Z MAR RJWZDMG

NNNN

Redmond, Oregon Sighting - 24 Sept 1959

1. Major Friend, by telephone, contacted Mr Laverne Wertz, FAA, Redmond, Oregon, Mr Robert Dickerson, policeman, Redmond, Oregon and Major Creasman, 827th ACWRON, Keno, Oregon. Mr Wertz stated that the object which was seen at 1200Z (0400 local) was brought to his attention by officer Dickerson. Wertz and Dickerson both described the object as an extremely bright light in the northeastern sky, and very low on the horizon. The object appeared stationary, except for apparent erratic motion around its principal points. The object was observed for more than one hour. Mr Wertz reported the object to ARTC at Seattle, who in turn contacted the 827th ACWRON for identification. Interceptors were scrambled from Seattle and surveyed the area under the control of the 827th. A civilian tri-pacer equipped with a geiger counter was scrambled from Redmond. The results of all intercept attempts were unsuccessful.

2. Major Creasman, 827th ACWRON informed Major Friend that a similar object has been observed several times since the 24th of September by the station's observers. It is believed at the station that either a gap-filler antenna or the terrain is responsible for the returns.

3. On the night of 24 September, Seattle ARTC asked the 827th if they had a target in the vicinity of Redmond. The operator observing the returns on the scope answered in the affirmative. It is believed that this unconfirmed and idle answer was responsible for the FAA report which stated that the visually observed UFO had radar confirmation by the GCI site.

4. At the time of the sighting the star Regulus and the planet Venus are both in the direction of the sighting and just below the horizon. It is the ATIC opinion that refractions of these objects were probably responsible for the visual sighting. The description by the witnesses and the fact that the object appeared generally stationary adds credence to this conclusion.

5. Col Tacker, SAFOI-3d, informed of ATIC action by telephone 14 June 1960. Col Shoop also briefed this date.

6. The following aircraft were scrambled for intercept and/or search of this target:

# A/C	Type A/C	From	Time Scr	Time Down
2	F-102	Portland, Ore	1300Z	1420Z
2	F-102	" "	1452Z	1529Z
1	F-102	" "	1608Z	1700+Z
1	Tri-Pacer	Redmond, Ore	1613Z	1821Z
1	F-102	Portland, Ore	1713Z	Unk
1	F-89	" "	1824Z	1929Z
1	H-29	Kingsley Fld	1949Z	2154Z

UFO SIGHTING
REDMOND, OREGON SIGHTING
24 September 1959

On 24 September 1959, at 1200Z (0400 local), Mr Robert Dickerson, a policeman of Redmond, Oregon, sighted an unidentified flying object. Unable to identify the object, Mr. Dickerson drove to the Redmond FAA facility and contacted Mr Laverne Wertz, operator on duty. Mr Dickerson and Mr. Wertz described the object as an extremely bright light very low on the horizon in the northeastern sky. Both witnesses stated that the object appeared to move erratically around a principal point and to move rapidly toward and away from them. Total observation time was approximately one hour at which time Mr Wertz stated that the object appeared to zoom straight up at great speed.

After observing the object for several minutes with Mr. Wertz, Officer Dickerson attempted to get closer to the object by driving in an eastward direction. After five miles and no apparent change in the appearance of the object the officer gave up the attempt and Mr Wertz reported the presence of the object to the FAA at Seattle by "Hot-Phone". The Seattle FAA facility contacted the 827th ACWRON (Aircraft Control and Warning Squadron) located at Keno, Oregon, and asked if they had a target in the Richmond area and the senior controller answered in the affirmative. Six F-102's, one F-89, one H-29(Helicopter), and one civilian Tri-Pacer equipped with a geiger counter were vectored to the target area with negative results. The interceptors did not make visual or radar contact and the Tri-Pacer reported negative on radiation. After the unsuccessful intercept, the 25th Air Division ordered the track number assigned to this target scrubbed.

The UFO report made to ATIC did not contain any information concerning the radar target, but concerned itself only with the visual sighting by Mr. Dickerson and Mr. Wertz. The reason the radar experience was omitted is that the Air Force recognized that the two sightings were really separate events. The FAA log associated the visual and radar sightings. These logs were later made available to Major Donald E. Keyhoe and he attempted to exploit them in an effort to prove that the Air Force was witholding information.

ATIC interviewed Officer Dickerson, Mr. Wertz, and Major Creasman of the 827th ACWRON, and confirmed the fact that the visual and radar sightings were associated only as coincidences. This conversation also narrowed down the direction and elevation, the apparent motions, and the colors and their arrangement associated with the object. From this information it was concluded that the cause for the visual sighting was the refraction of light from the planet Venus. The direction of the planet coincides with that reported for the object, and the planet had a stellar magnitude of -4.2, or about 15 times brighter than the brightest star. At the initial time of the sighting the planet was slightly below the horizon and was brought into view by the bending of light (refraction) by the atmosphere. Inconsistencies in the atmosphere probably caused the object to appear to have radial motion (toward and away from the observer).

The radar return was determined to have been caused by a gap-filler antenna. Under certain atmospheric conditions this antenna appears on the scope of the 827th ACWRON, and has been observed several times since the 24 September 1959 sighting.